

QUESTOR

HR User Guide

Logging in, running a first-round interview, and signing off the outcome

For	Recruiters, hiring managers, reviewers
What Questor does	Runs a structured, voice-first first-round interview, transcribes it, and produces an evidence-backed assessment
What it does not do	It never rejects anyone. Every outcome is a recommendation; a named human records the final decision, with a reason
Browser	Chrome or Edge

Contains guidance on handling candidate personal data. Share inside the hiring team only.

Technical companion documents: [docs/DEPLOYMENT.md](#) · [docs/VALIDATION.md](#) · [docs/compliance/](#)

1 Before you sign in

YOU NEED	DETAIL
The Questor address	Your IT administrator gives you this. On a local install it is <code>http://localhost:5173</code>
Your own account	One login per person — never a shared one (see section 2)
A browser	Chrome or Edge. Voice capture uses the browser's own speech engine, which Safari and Firefox do not fully implement. Candidates on other browsers can still type their answers
A microphone	Only for the interview room. Not needed for reviewing

2 Logging in

Go to the Questor address and enter your email and password on the sign-in page.

Your credentials

Questor does not ship with a personal account for you. There are exactly two ways an account exists.

1. The demo account — test machines only

Created by the setup script on a development machine:

Email	demo@questor.local
Password	questor123

This password is published in the public source code. It is for trying the product out on a test machine only, and it must be **deleted before the first real candidate** — a required item on the go-live checklist.

2. A real account — created for you by an administrator

Ask your Questor administrator to create one and to tell you your role (section 3). They should send the password through a channel that is not email, and you should treat it like any other HR system credential.

There is no “Register” shortcut for real use. The register link on the login page creates a brand-new, separate organisation with its own empty database — it does not give you access to your colleagues' candidates. It is switched off entirely on a production install.

Rules the login enforces

RULE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU
Sessions last 1 hour	You are signed out after an hour and need to sign in again. This is deliberate: Questor holds candidate personal data and often runs on a shared desk
10 failed attempts per 15 minutes	Repeated wrong passwords temporarily block sign-in. Wait 15 minutes rather than retrying
Passwords are at least 12 characters	Applies to any account your administrator creates
Never share a login	The audit log records who viewed and changed each assessment. Under a shared login, “who accessed this candidate's data?” has no answer — and candidates have a legal right to ask

Forgotten password

Questor currently has **no self-service password reset and no “change my password” screen**. If you forget your password, your administrator has to issue a new account or reset the stored password directly. Raise this with IT before rollout — see the appendix.

Signing out

Use **Sign out** at the bottom of the left sidebar. Always do this if you are stepping away from a shared machine.

3 What each role can do

Your administrator sets your role when creating your account. Roles are deliberately separated so that the person who writes a scorecard is not the person who signs it off.

	RECRUITER	MANAGER	REVIEWER	AUDITOR	ADMIN
Create a role / edit scorecard	✓	✓	—	—	✓
Approve a scorecard	—	✓	—	—	✓
Add candidates & resumes	✓	—	—	—	✓
View candidates	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
Create / invite / schedule interviews	✓	✓	—	—	✓
Run the interview room	✓	—	—	—	✓
Read assessments	✓	✓	✓	—	✓
Record the final decision	—	✓	✓	—	✓
Export to ATS	—	✓	—	—	✓
Read the audit log	—	—	—	✓	✓
Manage users, connectors, retention	—	—	—	—	✓

Two things follow from this table, and both are intentional:

- **A recruiter cannot approve the scorecard they wrote.** Ask a manager or admin to approve it.
- **A recruiter cannot sign off the outcome of an interview they ran.** A manager or reviewer records the decision.

You also only see the roles and candidates you are assigned to. An administrator controls those assignments.

4 The end-to-end workflow

The left sidebar is grouped by how often you use it: **Review** (your daily loop) on top, **Set up** below.

1 Create the role *Set up → New role*

1. Paste the **full job description**. The title is optional — Questor infers it if you leave it blank.
2. Submit. Questor produces a **Role Success Profile**: outcomes, responsibilities, a weighted competency model, red flags and prohibited topics.
3. Read it properly. This scorecard is what every candidate is measured against, and what an auditor will look at.
4. Correct anything wrong, then **Save**.
5. A manager or admin clicks **Approve**.

You cannot interview against an unapproved scorecard. Questor blocks it. This is the human approval gate, not a formality.

2 Add the candidate *Set up → Add candidate*

1. Pick the role.
2. Enter the candidate's full name and email.
3. Upload the resume (**PDF, DOCX or TXT**) — or paste the text.
4. Questor parses it and produces a **fit score** with the evidence behind it, plus **missing signals** and **suggested probes** for the interview to cover.

The fit score deliberately ignores age, caste, religion, nationality, marital status, appearance and accent. It is a starting point for the interview, not a screening decision.

3 Set up the interview *on the candidate's page*

Scroll to **Set up interview** and choose:

- **Duration** in minutes — the plan is built to fit the time you give it
- **Persona name** and **tone** — how the interviewer introduces itself
- **Provider** — leave as the hosted browser room unless IT says otherwise
- **Record of the interview** — what is retained

Click **Create interview**. Questor generates a versioned interview plan.

4 Invite the candidate *on the interview page*

1. Click **Send invitation**. This generates the candidate's private portal link.
2. **Check what the screen says about delivery**. Out of the box Questor does **not** actually send email — it only logs it. If the badge does not say *email sent*, or a note says the email could not be sent, **copy the portal link and send it to the candidate yourself**.
3. The badge then tracks three real states: *not sent* → *email sent* → *opened by candidate*. “Sent” only means the mail provider accepted it. If it is still unopened after a day, ask them to check spam.
4. Optionally set a **Schedule** date and time.

The portal link is a key. Anyone holding it can start that interview. Send it to the candidate only, and never forward it internally. **It expires after 14 days** — use **Resend email** to issue a fresh one.

5 What the candidate experiences

They open the link and pass three screens before anything is recorded:

1. **Review** — what the interview is, that it is conducted by an AI, and that it will be transcribed.
2. **Consent** — they explicitly agree. They can instead request **an accommodation or a human alternative**, which routes them to your team rather than into the interview. Honour that request.
3. **Audio check** — enable mic, play a test sound.

Then they join the room. The interviewer speaks, they answer aloud and press **Done answering**. They can interrupt it, ask it to repeat, or **type their answers** instead if voice is not working for them.

You can preview the room yourself with **Open interview room (recruiter preview)** — useful for training, and for showing a nervous candidate what to expect.

6 Read the transcript

The interview page shows the full **diarized, timestamped transcript** — who said what, when. This is the source of truth for everything that follows.

7 Review the assessment *Review → Interviews → the assessment*

Questor produces a competency scorecard, a summary, a full report, and a recommendation of **Proceed / Consider / Do-Not-Progress** with a confidence level. Dimensions without enough evidence are marked **Not Enough Evidence** rather than guessed.

Do the blind review first. Click **Review the evidence blind**. You score each competency from the transcript and evidence *before* Questor's conclusions are shown to you, then record your own recommendation. Only then does it reveal how your call compares with the AI's.

This is not busywork. A reviewer who reads the AI's verdict and then agrees with it is anchoring, not reviewing — and a regulator reads that as an automated decision with a rubber stamp on it. Blind-first review is what keeps the human oversight genuine and evidenced.

If you must skip it, Questor requires a written reason, which is recorded.

8 Record the decision

In **Human review** on the assessment page, set the **Disposition**, give a **Reason** (mandatory), add comments and submit. Your name is attached to it. Every previous review stays visible — nothing is overwritten.

Then, if your ATS is connected, **Export to ATS**.

5 Troubleshooting

SYMPTOM	WHAT TO DO
"Invalid credentials"	Check the email is exactly right. After 10 failures you are rate-limited — wait 15 minutes
Signed out unexpectedly	Sessions last 1 hour. Sign in again
Can't find the Approve button	You are a recruiter. Ask a manager or admin to approve
"Role scorecard must be approved before interviewing"	Step 1.5 — someone needs to approve the scorecard
Candidate says they got no email	Expected on a default install. Copy the portal link from the interview page and send it yourself
Candidate's link doesn't work	It expires after 14 days. Click Resend email for a new one
Candidate's voice isn't picked up	Ask them to use Chrome or Edge, allow the microphone, and reload. They can type answers instead — the interview still counts
A candidate asks not to be interviewed by an AI	They can request a human alternative on the consent screen. Route them to a human interview
You can't see a candidate you expect to see	You are only shown what you are assigned to. Ask an administrator

6 Honest limits — read before rollout

These are real gaps in the current build, not caveats for the sake of it.

- **No user-management screen.** Accounts are created through the API by an administrator (see the appendix). There is no "invite a colleague" button.
- **No password reset or password change.** Plan how IT handles a forgotten password before you roll out.
- **Email is not delivered by default.** Until SendGrid or SMTP is configured, every invitation must be copied and sent manually.
- **The database is not encrypted.** Candidate names, resumes and full transcripts sit in plain text in the database file. Filesystem permissions and separate operating-system accounts are the controls actually protecting it.
- **The demo account must be deleted** before any real candidate data goes in.
- **The AI's judgement is advisory and has not been validated on your roles.** Run it in shadow mode alongside your existing process and measure agreement before relying on it.
- **Candidate notices need your counsel's review.** Drafts exist, but nobody inside the engineering team can sign those off.

7 Your obligations as an HR user

- Tell candidates it is an AI interview, and that it is recorded and transcribed. The consent screen does this — do not work around it.
- Honour every accommodation or human-alternative request.
- Never ask, and never follow up on, protected characteristics. Questor blocks and rewrites prohibited questions, but the responsibility is yours.
- Decide from evidence. If a competency says **Not Enough Evidence**, that is information, not a negative.
- Write a real reason on every decision. It is what a candidate is entitled to see and what an auditor will read.
- One login per person, always.

Appendix — for your IT administrator

Creating HR accounts

There is no UI for this yet. An existing admin creates accounts via the API.

```
# 1. Sign in as an admin and capture the token
TOKEN=$(curl -s -X POST http://localhost:4000/api/auth/login \
  -H 'content-type: application/json' \
  -d '{"email":"admin@yourcompany.com","password":"<admin password>"}' \
  | node -pe 'JSON.parse(require("fs").readFileSync(0)).token')

# 2. Create an HR user
#   role: recruiter | manager | reviewer | auditor | admin
#   password: minimum 12 characters
curl -s -X POST http://localhost:4000/api/admin/users \
  -H "authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" \
  -H 'content-type: application/json' \
  -d '{"email":"jane@yourcompany.com","name":"Jane Doe","role":"recruiter","password":"<12+ chars>"}'

# 3. List users, or change someone's role
curl -s -H "authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" http://localhost:4000/api/admin/users

curl -s -X PATCH http://localhost:4000/api/admin/users/<userId>/role \
  -H "authorization: Bearer $TOKEN" -H 'content-type: application/json' \
  -d '{"role":"manager"}'
```

Notes:

- The **first** account on a fresh install is created through `POST /api/auth/register`, which mints the organisation and its first admin. Close self-registration again afterwards — it is closed by default in production.
- A role change does not affect an already-signed-in user until their session expires, within the hour.
- The last remaining admin cannot be demoted; it would lock the organisation out of user management permanently.
- Assign users to the requisitions and candidates they should see, via `POST /api/admin/users/:id/roles/:roleId` and `POST /api/admin/users/:id/candidates/:candidateId`. Without an assignment they see an empty console.

Before the first real candidate

The full go-live checklist is in `docs/DEPLOYMENT.md`. The items HR will notice most:

- ☐ Delete the `demo@questor.local` account
- ☐ Generate a real `AUTH_SECRET` — the default is published on GitHub
- ☐ Configure SendGrid or SMTP so invitations actually reach candidates
- ☐ Restrict filesystem permissions on the database (`scripts/harden-windows.ps1`)
- ☐ One operating-system account per HR user
- ☐ Set up backups, and restrict the backup location too